Public.com API - Quotes Endpoint: Official Documentation Extract

Answers to the quote-timestamp investigation questions (priorities 1-5), taken from Public.com's official API documentation. Field names and types are reproduced exactly; descriptions are condensed. Anything the documentation does not cover is marked "Not documented" - those items remain open questions for Public support.

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Primary source: https://public.com/api/docs/resources/market-data/get-quotes
Docs home:      https://public.com/api/docs
```

1. Quotes endpoint (Priority 1)

Method and path: POST /userapigateway/marketdata/{accountId}/quotes

Full URL: https://api.public.com/userapigateway/marketdata/{accountId}/quotes

The endpoint description states that it returns real-time market quotes for a set of instruments, requires the marketdata scope, and is available to individual investors. Supported instrument types: EQUITY, OPTION, CRYPTO, INDEX (the request type enum also lists MULTI_LEG_INSTRUMENT, ALT, TREASURY, BOND, EVENTCONTRACT).

Path parameter: accountId (string, required).

Request body (application/json, required): an "instruments" array; each item has "symbol" (string, required) and "type" (string enum, required).

Authentication: Bearer API key. Example from the docs:

```
curl --request POST \
  --url https://api.public.com/userapigateway/marketdata/{accountId}/quotes \
  --header 'Authorization: Bearer YOUR_API_KEY' \
  --header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
  --data '{"instruments": [{"symbol": "string", "type": "EQUITY"}]}'
```

400 response: invalid input - instrument not found, or the account is invalid or unauthorized.

Response schema - 200, object with a "quotes" array

Field	Type	Req.	Meaning (per official docs, condensed)
instrument	object	Yes	The instrument the quote is for ({symbol, type}).
outcome	string enum: SUCCESS, UNKNOWN	Yes	Outcome status of the quote request.
last	string	No	Last traded price. Null if no trades have occurred.
lastTimestamp	string (ISO 8601, UTC)	No	Timestamp of when the last trade occurred. Null if no trades have occurred.
bid	string	No	Current bid price. Null if no bid exists.
bidSize	integer	No	Shares, contracts, or units available at the bid price.
bidTimestamp	string (ISO 8601, UTC)	No	Timestamp of when the bid price was last updated. Null if no bid exists.
ask	string	No	Current ask price. Null if no ask exists.
askSize	integer	No	Shares, contracts, or units available at the ask price.
askTimestamp	string (ISO 8601, UTC)	No	Timestamp of when the ask price was last updated. Null if no ask exists.
volume	integer	No	Total volume traded on the date of the last trade.

Field	Type	Req.	Meaning (per official docs, condensed)
openInterest	integer	No	Total options contracts not closed or delivered on a particular day.
previousClose	string	No	Previous day's close price from the last trading session.
oneDayChange	object	No	{change (string, dollars), percentChange (string)}. Values are supplied by the data source (e.g., Xignite) and may differ from last minus previousClose due to corporate actions, splits, or other adjustments.
optionDetails	object	No	{greeks {delta, gamma, theta, vega, rho, impliedVolatility} (strings), strikePrice (string, required), midPrice (string - average of bid and ask; null if bid/ask unavailable)}.
bondDetails	object	No	Bond-specific fields (all strings): askMinSize, bidMinSize, askMarkup, bidMarkup, suggestedBuyPrice, suggestedSellPrice, minBuyAmount, minBuyIncrementAmount.

Note: the schema contains NO server-time field, NO quote-age or freshness field, and NO data-quality / market-quality field. All timestamps are ISO 8601 in UTC (e.g., 2023-11-07T05:31:56Z in the docs example).

Example response (as shown in the docs)


```
{
  "quotes": [
    {
      "instrument": {
        "symbol": "string",
        "type": "EQUITY"
      },
      "outcome": "SUCCESS",
      "last": "string",
      "lastTimestamp": "2023-11-07T05:31:56Z",
      "bid": "string",
      "bidSize": 123,
      "bidTimestamp": "2023-11-07T05:31:56Z",
      "ask": "string",
      "askSize": 123,
      "askTimestamp": "2023-11-07T05:31:56Z",
      "volume": 1234567890,
      "openInterest": 1234567890,
      "previousClose": "string",
      "oneDayChange": {
        "change": "string",
        "percentChange": "string"
      },
      "optionDetails": {
        "greeks": {
          "delta": "string",
          "gamma": "string",
          "theta": "string",
          "vega": "string",
          "rho": "string",
          "impliedVolatility": "string"
        },
        "strikePrice": "string",
        "midPrice": "string"
      },
      "bondDetails": {
```

```
          "askMinSize": "string",
          "bidMinSize": "string",
          "askMarkup": "string",
          "bidMarkup": "string",
          "suggestedBuyPrice": "string",
          "suggestedSellPrice": "string",
          "minBuyAmount": "string",
          "minBuyIncrementAmount": "string"
        }
      }
    ]
  }
```

2. Timestamp semantics (Priority 2)

What the docs state - the complete documentation for the three timestamp fields is the one-line description of each (Section 1):

- lastTimestamp = when the last trade occurred.
- bidTimestamp = when the bid price was last updated.
- askTimestamp = when the ask price was last updated.

Not documented:

- No further distinction between trade-execution time, quote-generation time, and server time appears anywhere in the docs.
- No stale threshold mechanism is documented. The parameter name "max_age" does not appear anywhere in the documentation - it is not a documented quotes parameter.
- No document explains stale-data behavior or any client- or server-side freshness window.

Reading for the investigation (interpretation, not documentation): by the documented definitions, lastTimestamp is tied to trade prints only, while bid/ask timestamps are tied to quote updates. A lastTimestamp that stays unchanged while bidTimestamp and askTimestamp advance is therefore consistent with the documented definitions whenever no new trade occurs - but the docs never state this explicitly, and they are silent on session-specific exceptions (next section).

3. Sessions and market hours (Priorities 3 and 5)

For the quotes endpoint specifically: Not documented. There is no market-hours or sessions page in the docs, and nothing describes how quotes or their timestamps behave in regular hours vs. pre-market vs. after-hours. In particular, no document states whether Last/lastTimestamp are expected to remain unchanged while Bid/Ask advance during extended sessions.

The only session definitions anywhere in the docs belong to a different endpoint - Get bars v2 (chart data), via its tradingSessionToggle parameter, which applies only to DAY and WEEK equity charts, not to quotes:

- REGULAR_HOURS - 09:30-16:00 ET only.
- REGULAR_AND_EXTENDED_HOURS - 04:00-20:00 ET (the default).
- ALL_SESSIONS - adds overnight ATS sessions; on DAY charts this adds separate preMarketOvernight (00:00-04:00) and postMarketOvernight (20:00-24:00) fields; on WEEK charts it merges full 24/5 coverage into one series.

Related changelog item (2026-07-02): 24/5 trading is available via the API by setting the equity attribute equityMarketSession to TWENTY_FOUR_HOURS. This concerns order placement only and says nothing about quote data behavior per session.

4. Freshness and stale indicators (Priority 4)

- No freshness guarantees and no latency expectations are documented. The only characterization anywhere is the word "real-time" in the endpoint description.

- No stale threshold (of any value) is documented for the quotes endpoint.
- The response provides no freshness indicator, no data-age field, and no market-quality / data-quality field (see the schema note in Section 1).
- The only timestamps available for judging data age are lastTimestamp, bidTimestamp, and askTimestamp themselves.

5. Volume field (Priority 4)

Documented definition (complete): volume is an integer - "the total volume traded on the date of the last trade." In other words, cumulative traded volume for the trade date of the most recent trade, not a per-quote or per-interval volume.

Not documented: how often volume updates relative to the price fields, and whether volume updates are correlated with lastTimestamp updates.

6. What the official docs do not answer - for Public support

1. Is lastTimestamp strictly the execution time of the most recent trade print, or can it be refreshed by quote-side activity?

2. During pre-market and after-hours sessions, is it expected behavior for last and lastTimestamp to remain at the last regular-session trade while bid/ask and their timestamps keep updating?

3. Is there any caching or TTL on quotes endpoint responses, and what end-to-end freshness should clients expect for last vs. bid/ask?

4. Does volume update only when a trade occurs? Does it include extended-hours trades, and why is it defined relative to "the date of the last trade"?

5. Which upstream provider supplies the quote fields (the docs name Xignite for oneDayChange), and are the timestamps source-provided or generated by Public?

6. Is there any supported way (parameter, header, or field) for a client to request or verify quote freshness - e.g., an equivalent of a max_age parameter?

Sources and method

Checked on 2026-10-20: the Get quotes reference page (URL above), plus the option chain, bars, Guides, Additional Info, Changelog, and SDKs/Tools pages of the same docs site, and a site-wide check for the terms "max_age", "stale", and session behavior for quotes. No public OpenAPI/Swagger file exists for this API (https://public.com/api/docs/openapi.json returns Access Denied; no spec link appears on any docs page), so the rendered reference page is the authoritative source and its schema is captured in full in Section 1.